Meeting Prep Tool

Page 1: Before the meeting. Get your thoughts out of your head and onto the page.

Your one on one is time for you. It is not a check up. Use it to talk through your work, name any roadblocks and work with your manager on a path forward. Fill in this page a day or two before you meet.

YOUR NAME	DATE	MEETING WITH	MEETING TYPE
			Choose one

1 Where things stand

Share it before they ask.

PROJECT OR TASK	STATUS	NEXT STEP	DUE
	Select		
	Select		
	Select		
	Select		

2 Wins to share

Your manager cannot advocate for work they do not know you did.

3 Roadblocks

Bring your thinking along with the problem.

WHAT IS STUCK	WHAT I TRIED	MY IDEA FOR A PATH FORWARD	WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

Not sure when to ask for help?

Try it on your own first. Do not sit on it for days. When you ask, show what you tried, how you thought it through and your specific question. As long as you show effort, people will want to help.

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Page 2: Get ready to show up. Plan what you will say and how you will feel steady.

4 My questions

Asking beats guessing wrong.

1.
2.
3.

5 One thing to bring up

A question or observation helps you join in.

6 Anything to flag now?

Good judgment means knowing what to raise.

7 What your manager counts on

Check each one you feel ready on.

- [ ] **Transparency** I can share where things stand before I am asked.
- [ ] **Ownership** I own my work, including what went sideways.
- [ ] **Judgment** I know what needs to be raised and what can wait.
- [ ] **Reliability** I am on track to deliver on time.
- [ ] **Honesty** I will ask when I am unsure instead of guessing.

8 Show up ready

Use your tools. They help you focus and stay steady.

BRING WITH YOU

- [ ] Pen and paper
- [ ] This prep tool
- [ ] A cold drink
- [ ] A fidget, if it helps
- [ ] Phone put away

SETTLE IN

- [ ] Move my body before the meeting
- [ ] A breathing or grounding exercise
- [ ] Arrive on time and stay until the end
- [ ] Virtual: camera on, mic muted
- [ ] Virtual: eyes on or near the camera

If you get caught off guard

1. Take a breath. 2. Take a sip of your drink. 3. Give yourself time with a phrase like:

"That is a great question and I want to give it some thought. Let me follow up with you later today."

MY OWN GO TO PHRASE

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Page 3: During and after. Capture it now so you do not have to hold it in your head.

9 Meeting notes

What was decided? What did you learn?

10 Action items

Add each one to your calendar or to do list today.

ACTION ITEM	OWNER	DUE DATE	ON MY LIST
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

11 Follow up

A short email confirms what you heard.

☐ I need to send a follow up email

☐ Notes saved to my project folder

SUBJECT LINE (BE SPECIFIC, LIKE: STATUS UPDATE ON THE HENDERSON REPORT)

WHAT I WANT TO CONFIRM OR ASK

12 Learn how your manager works

Notice a little more each time you meet.

THEY LIKE UPDATES	THEY COMMUNICATE	WHEN I AM STUCK
Not sure yet	Not sure yet	Not sure yet

WHAT I NOTICED THIS TIME